

Plant Knowledge 1

Science

May, 2026

Plant Knowledge 1 (A08322)

Short Title:	Plant Knowledge 1	
Faculty	Science and Computing	
Department	Science	
Cluster	Horticulture	
Author	LCASSIN	
Credits	5	Level: Introductory

Description of Module / Aims

This module for horticulturists will introduce the learner to a range of plant material, the use of botanical names, industry specifications for plants and planting techniques, turf grass establishment and maintenance, plant identification and identification of grass genera.

Programmes

HORT -0036	BSc in Horticulture (WD_SHORT_D)	1 / 1 / M
HORT -0036	BSc in Horticulture (WD_SHORT_DX)	1 / 1 / M

Indicative Content

- Classification: Binomial system
- Categorizing trees, shrubs, perennial
- Plant selection and planting specification for the landscape industry
- Plant identification of 60 plants
- Turfgrass establishment
- Identification of Grass Genera

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Identify a range of plants using the correct botanical names.
2. Describe and categorise plant material.
3. Describe the industry specifications for plant material.
4. Describe and select appropriate planting techniques.
5. Describe turfgrass establishment.
6. Identify the main grass genera.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Using live plant material.
- Lectures
- Practical demonstrations.
- Visit to plant producers and retailers.

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Final Written Examination	50%	2,3,4,5
Continuous Assessment	50%	
<i>Practical</i>	50%	1,6

Assessment Criteria

<40%: Not able to identify 40% of plants with botanical names, cannot describe key industry plant description, cannot describe seed bed preparation.

40%-49%: Can identify at least 40 % of plants with botanical names, can describe key industry plant descriptions, can select and describe planting techniques, and understands principles of seed bed preparation.

50%-59%: All of the above and achieves 50% of plants identified, can describe seed bed preparation, sowing and sodding.

60%-69%: All the above with 60% of plants identified correctly with no spelling errors.

70%-100%: All of the above and 70% of plants identified correctly with no spelling errors.

Note:

- In addition to the normal regulations, a minimum of 35% must be achieved in both the final exam and continuous assessment components of the module. In cases where continuous assessment has a practical component attendance of at least 75% in the practicals is mandatory.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Lecture	24	
Practical	24	
Independent Learning	87	

Essential Material

- Brickell, C. *Royal Horticultural Society A-Z Encyclopedia of Garden Plants* [BOX SET]. London: Dorling Kindersley, 2008.
- Fitter, A. *Trees* (Collins Gem Series). London: HarperCollins Publisher, 2004.
- Johnson, A.T. *Plant Names Simplified*. Swadlincote: Landsmans Bookshop Limited, 1972.
- Turgeon, A.J. *Turfgrass Management*. Upper Saddle River N.J.: Pearson Prentice Hall, 2009.